Q WHO DO YOU THINK IS INDIA'S NO. 1 HEROINE?



GETTY IMAGES

1 DEEPIKA PADUKONE
9.4%
[21.2%]

2 KATRINA KAIF
7.5%
[9.2%]

3 PRIYANKA CHOPRA-JONAS
4.6%
[7.9%]

4 ANUSHKA SHARMA
4.6%
[4.8%]

5 ALIA BHATT
3.3%
[8.7%]

Q WHO IS THE NO. 1 OTT STAR (MALE) IN THE COUNTRY?



1 ABHISHEK BACHCHAN
16.8%
[10.2%]



2 MANOJ BAJPAYEE
10.6%
[20.7%]



3 PANKAJ TRIPATHI
8.6%
[13.3%]



4 BOBBY DEOL
8.2%
[8.5%]



5 NAWAZUDDIN SIDDIQUI
7.1%
[10.3%]

Q WHO IS THE NO. 1 OTT STAR (FEMALE) IN THE COUNTRY?



1 RAVEENA TANDON
20%
[12.5%]



2 SUSHMITA SEN
18.8%
[21.9%]



3 HUMA QURESHI
6.8%
[8.9%]



4 POOJA BHATT
5.8%
[5.8%]



5 RADHIKA APTE
5.2%
[13.7%]

Rest others; Jan. 2023 figs in bold; Aug. 2022 in brackets

"Besharam Rang" drew the ire of a few BJP leaders and Hindu fringe groups, who called for its boycott and threatened to disrupt its release. Nearly 40 per cent of MOTN respondents feel that such calls are nothing but "smear campaigns by some vested interest groups", which should not be taken seriously. Going by the first-day collections of *Pathaan*—estimated to be Rs 50 crore—it seems that most cinemagoers pay no heed to such demands.

The backlash to "Besharam Rang" didn't affect Padukone's prospects in the survey. She continued her reign as the top heroine, albeit she wasn't as invincible as in August 2022. She will be betting big on *Pathaan*, her first theatrical release since *Chhapaak* (2020), and *Project K*, which will see her collaborate with Bachchan and Prabhas. Katrina Kaif and Priyanka Chopra rounded off the top three. They are expected to star alongside Alia Bhatt (who finished fifth), in Farhan Akhtar's *Jee Le Zara*, a much-awaited road trip film.

On the OTT front, another Bachchan was on top. Abhishek, fresh off the success of *Breathe: Into the Shadows* season two, pulled ahead of Manoj Bajpayee (*The Family Man*), Pankaj Tripathi (*Criminal Justice: Adhura Sach*) and Bobby Deol (*Ashram* and *Love Hostel*). Abhishek relishes the opportunities coming his way via OTT platforms that prioritise storytelling. Among OTT actresses, the biggest benefactors have been Raveena Tandon and Sushmita Sen, whose professional careers have seen a revival after they shouldered long-format narratives in *Aranyak* and *Aarya*, respectively. ■

Q WHAT DO YOU THINK OF RECENT SOCIAL MEDIA TRENDS ASKING FOR BOYCOTT OF CERTAIN FILMS?

